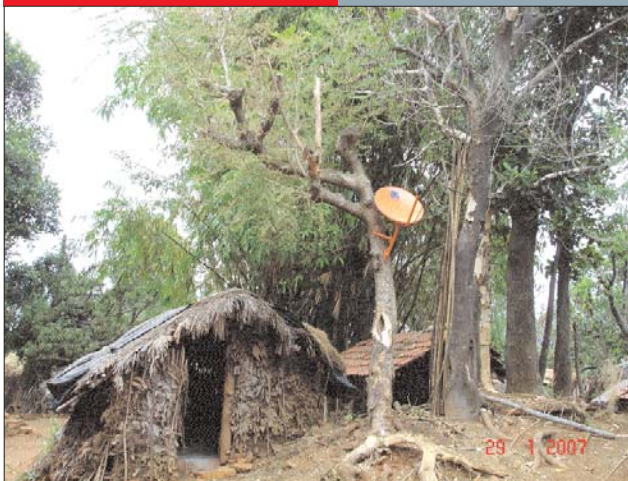


DigiPick of the month

"Life's Little Luxuries"



Last month's winner is

Amit Mittal

Thane, Maharashtra

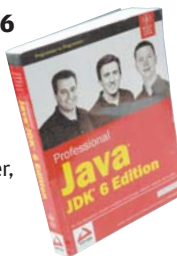
Participate and win next month

Java JDK 6 Edition

by W. Clay Richardson, Donald Avondolio, Scot Schrager, Mark W. Mitchell & Jeff Scanlon

Published by

WILEY-INDIA



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **"DigiPick"** and your postal address **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

president when he said the country had become an IT-savvy nation (or something like that) because of using pirated Windows and Office. But that was the Romanian president. Will he sack Raikes?

Now that the cat is out of the bag, we can ask: if they're saying "Pirate Windows if you must pirate," why not shorten that to "Pirate Windows"? It comes to the same thing...

FIRST, DO NO HARM

Defragging Drive

A Thai game developer, obviously not in touch with the times, is developing a goodness game. That's not what he calls it, but the aim of the game is to be good—according to the tenets of Buddhism. These happen to be: do not kill, do not steal, do not commit adultery, do not lie, and do not drink alcohol. Now we haven't seen a game where you get points for quaffing on a bottle of Jack, but except for

that, you pretty much do all the rest of those no-nos in today's games. (Witness *GTA: San Andreas*—the "Hot Coffee" mod—for the third of the vices.)

The good man, called Pakorn Tancharoen (don't blame him, he didn't name himself), is a senior officer in Thailand's Religious Affairs Department. He got concerned about the moral impact of gaming when he heard about a boy who attacked his mother when she wouldn't pay for an online gaming session.

Tsk, tsk. That's not behaviour anyone would condone, but Tancharoen went to the extent of developing this game where you follow three children on a pilgrimage with a wise old monk. You have to deal with obstacles along the way, of course, but you have to be good while doing it. No fragging old monks. No drinking Old Monk. No fragging monkeys, either—even shooting animals will cost you points.

Since that's the report, we assume you can frag people, so it might still be a normal game—the man with the highest negative

score wins. How alarmed the good man would be if people began doing such bad things with his game!

Thai people can download the game at www.khondee.net/game. No, you won't be blocked if you're non-Thai, but the page and the game are in Thai, so it's not much fun going there, is it? Still, how about checking out the graphics and the AI and dropping us a line? Seriously! Do the monks actually turn the other cheek and stuff?

We're being frivolous about the whole thing, which is not good, we know. It's only that we don't believe that gaming causes violent behaviour; we don't believe that anyone will play this game without giggling; we don't believe people won't frag some monks.

With this announcement, we can think of similar games to address many of the world's problems and create better people.

Feed The Hungry: Here, you get points for collecting pieces of food. You get bonuses when you feed

People Who Changed Computing

The Younger Steve

Steven Jobs is co-founder and CEO of Apple, the company that has captured the imaginations of millions, and is renowned for great design of products.

After his schooling, he enrolled in Reed (a college in Portland) only to drop out after his first semester.



Steve Jobs

Returning to California, he took up a job as a technician at Atari, and was offered \$100 (a lot back then) for every chip that he could reduce in size on a gaming circuit board. Jobs partnered with Steve Wozniak and decided to split the offer, and Wozniak reduced the number of chips by 50 per cent.

It was around this time that Jobs noticed Wozniak's computer, which the latter had designed himself for his own use. Jobs convinced Wozniak to start a company together, and started off manufacturing printed circuit boards. In the end, however, they ended up manufacturing assembled computers. A few years later, Jobs was ousted from his own company when it was making losses, but in 1997 he returned to the company as interim CEO. Jobs, after his return, emphasised the importance of design and public appeal with the finished quality that Apple is now synonymous with.

Here's a toast to Steve Jobs, the man who started making things prettier—not just at Apple, because competitors were forced to follow suit in order to match (or better) the functionality and elegance of design that Apple's products exude to this day.